

S. floribundum. Evergreen, tufted, short-stemmed perennial. H and S to 1ft (30cm). Produces clusters of lance-shaped, long-pointed, long-stalked, glossy, dark green leaves, to 6in (15cm) long. Intermittently bears narrowly ovate, white spathes, to 3in (8cm) long, each enclosing a green-and-white spadix. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Mauna Loa’ illus. p.468.

S. wallisii (Peace lily) illus. p.468.

‘Clevelandii’ (syn. S. ‘Clevelandii’) is an evergreen, tufted perennial. H and S to 2ft (60cm). Has broadly lance-shaped, semi-erect, glossy, mid-green leaves, 1ft (30cm) or more long. Intermittently bears ovate, white spathes, each 6in (15cm) long, with a central, green line, that surround fragrant, white spadices. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

SPATHODEA

BIGNONIACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen tree, grown for its showy, bell-shaped flowers and large, pinnate leaves. Frost tender. Needs full light and fertile, well-drained, moist soil. Young and pot-grown plants seldom flower. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.

S. campanulata (African tulip tree, Flame-of-the-forest) illus. p.453.

SPHAERALCEA

MALVACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials, and deciduous subshrubs, evergreen in warm climates, grown for their mallowlike flowers. Fully hardy to frost hardy. Needs a warm, sunny site and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or division in spring, or by softwood cuttings in midsummer.

S. ambigua illus. p.246.

S. munroana. Woody-based, gray-hairy perennial with unbranched stems. H and S 1½ft (45cm). Has ovate to almost diamond-shaped, shallowly lobed or scalloped, mid-green leaves. Bears saucer-shaped, bright reddish-orange flowers in many-flowered axillary and terminal panicles from midsummer to early fall. Z4–10

Sphaeropteris. See *Cyathea*.

SPIRAEA

ROSACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen shrubs, grown for their abundant, small flowers and, in some species, their foliage. Fully hardy. Requires sun and fertile, well-drained but not over-dry soil. On species and cultivars that flower on the current year’s growth—*S. x billiardii*, *S. douglasii* and *S. japonica* and its cultivars—cut back young stems and remove very old ones in early spring. On species that flower on old wood, cut out older shoots in early spring, leaving young shoots to flower that year. Propagate *S. douglasii* by division from late fall to early spring, other species and cultivars by softwood cuttings in summer.

S. ‘Arguta’ (Bridal wreath, Foam of May). Deciduous, arching, dense shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Produces clusters of 5-petaled, white flowers from mid- to late spring. Leaves are narrowly oblong and bright green. Z5–8

S. x cinerea ‘Grefsheim’. Dense-growing, deciduous shrub. H and S 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m). Produces downy, arching stems and narrowly elliptic or lance-shaped, light sea-green leaves, downy above when young, with flattened silky hairs beneath. In mid-spring, before the leaves, bears corymbs of small, white flowers. Z4–7

S. japonica ‘Anthony Waterer’ illus. p.154.

‘Candlelight’ is a compact, clump-forming deciduous shrub. H 2–2½ft (60–75cm), S 36–39in (90–100cm). Butter-yellow spring foliage turns greenish yellow, then often fiery red in fall. Bears purplish pink flowers.

GOLDEN PRINCESS (‘Lisp’). H 20in (50cm), S 3ft (1m), has bronze-gold young leaves, later bright yellow leaves, orange-yellow in fall, and bright purplish pink flowers.

‘Goldflame’ illus. p.156.

‘Little Princess’ illus. p.153.

MAGIC CARPET (‘Walbuma’). H 2ft (60cm), S 3ft (90cm), is a lower-growing version of ‘Goldflame’, producing smaller leaves that are greenish yellow with bright red tips when young, turning pale gold, then orange and red in fall, and purplish pink flowers. Z3–8

S. nipponica. Deciduous, arching shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Bears dense clusters of 5-petaled, white flowers in early summer. Stout, red shoots bear small, rounded, dark green leaves. Z4–8.

‘Halward’s Silver’, H and S 3ft (1m), is slow-growing, very dense, and flowers profusely.

‘Snowmound’ (syn. *S.n.* var. *tosanensis* of gardens) illus. p.131.

S. prunifolia. Deciduous, arching, graceful shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). In mid- and late spring, bears clusters of rosettelike, double, white flowers amid rounded to oblong, bright green leaves, coloring to bronze-yellow in fall. Z5–8

S. thunbergii. Deciduous or semi-evergreen, arching, dense shrub. H 5ft (1.5m), S 6ft (2m). Small clusters of 5-petaled, white flowers are borne from early to mid-spring. Has lance-shaped, pale green leaves. Z5–8

S. x vanhouttei (Bridal wreath) illus. p.145.

‘Gold Fountain’ is a compact, bushy, deciduous shrub. H 6ft (2m), S 5ft (1.5m). Has slender, arching shoots with golden yellow foliage in spring, turning greenish yellow by midsummer. In early summer, bears bowl-shaped, white flowers in dense corymbs along the shoots.

‘Pink Ice’, H 4ft (1.2m), S 3ft (1m), is slow-growing with white-flecked leaves that can revert. Z4–7

SPIRANTHES

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

S. cernua (illus. p.466). Deciduous, terrestrial orchid. H 20in (50cm). Spikes of delicate, white flowers, ½in (1cm) long, with pale yellow centers, are produced in fall. Has narrowly lance-shaped leaves, 2–5in (5–12cm) long. Requires partial shade in summer. Z4–8

SPREKELIA

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of one species of bulb, grown for its showy, red flowers in spring. Frost tender. Needs an open, sunny site and well-drained soil. Keep dry in winter;

start into growth by watering in spring. Propagate by offsets in early fall.

S. formosissima (Aztec lily, Jacobean lily) illus. p.402.

STACHYS

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of late spring- or summer-flowering annuals, perennials and shrubs, some of which are evergreen, grown for their foliage and for their flowers. Fully hardy. Grows in any well-drained soil, tolerating even poor soil. Species listed below prefer an open, sunny site; others are woodland plants and are best in partial shade. Propagate by division in spring.

S. byzantina, syn. *S. lanata*, *S. olympica* (Lamb’s tongue), illus. p.274.

‘Primrose Heron’ illus. p.275.

‘Silver Carpet’ is an evergreen, mat-forming perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has oblong-elliptic to lance-shaped, woolly, gray leaves. Rarely produces flowers. Good as a front-of-border or ground-cover plant. Z4–8

S. coccinea. Clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has ovate-lance-shaped or oblong-triangular, mid-green leaves with a pronounced network of veins. Dense spikes of small, hooded, bright scarlet flowers, protruding from purple calyces, arise from leaf axils, from early to late summer. Z4–8

S. lanata. See *S. byzantina*.

S. macrantha. Clump-forming perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). Has broadly ovate, crinkled, round-toothed, soft green leaves. Dense spikes of large, hooded, rose-purple flowers are produced in summer. Z7–9.

‘Superba’ illus. p.270.

S. officinalis, syn. *Betonica officinalis* (Betony). Mat-forming perennial. H 18–24in (45–60cm), S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). Produces dense spikes of hooded, tubular, purple, pink or white flowers on sturdy stems, arising, in summer, from mats of ovate-oblong to oblong, round-toothed, mid-green leaves. Z5–8.

‘Hummelo’ illus. p.268.

‘Rosea’ has flowers of clearer pink.

S. olympica. See *S. byzantina*.

STACHYURUS

STACHYURACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen shrubs, grown for their 4-petaled flowers, which are borne before the leaves emerge. Fully to frost hardy; flower spikes, formed in fall, are usually unharmed by hard frosts. Requires a position in sun or partial shade, and fertile, moist but well-drained, not too heavy soil, preferably peaty and acidic. Does well when trained against a south- or west-facing wall. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

S. chinensis. Deciduous, spreading, open shrub. H 6ft (2m), S 12ft (4m). In late winter and early spring, bears pendent spikes of small, bell-shaped, pale yellow flowers. Leaves are ovate and dark green. Z8–9.

‘Celina’ bears 50–60 flowers in racemes to 9in (23cm) long.

‘Joy Forever’ has leaves with wide yellow margins, sometimes all-yellow.

‘Magpie’ see *S. ‘Magpie’*.

S. ‘Magpie’, syn. *S. chinensis* ‘Magpie’, *S. praecox* ‘Magpie’. Deciduous, spreading, open shrub. H 5ft (1.5m), S 6ft (2m). Has arching, red-purple shoots and ovate,

tapered, gray-green leaves, edged creamy-white. Bell-shaped, pale yellow flowers are borne in late winter and early spring. H5

S. praecox illus. p.144.

‘Magpie’ see *S. ‘Magpie’*.

STANHOPEA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

S. tigrina. Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 9in (23cm). Pendent spikes of fragrant, waxy, rich yellow and maroon flowers, 6in (15cm) across, with red-spotted, white lips, are produced in summer. Has broadly ovate, ribbed leaves, 1ft (30cm) long. Best grown in a hanging, slatted basket. Provide partial shade in summer. Z11–12 (min. 52–55°F/11–13°C; max. 86°F/30°C)

STAPELIA

APOCYNACEAE/ASCLEPIADACEAE

Genus of clump-forming, perennial succulents with erect, 4-angled stems. Stem edges are often indented and may bear small leaves that drop after only a few weeks. Flowers are often foul-smelling. Frost tender. Requires a position in sun or partial shade, and moderately fertile, gritty, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

S. europaea. See *Caralluma europaea*.

S. flavirostris. See *S. grandiflora*.

S. gigantea illus. p.496.

S. grandiflora, syn. *S. flavirostris*, illus. p.488.

S. variegata. See *Orbea variegata*.

STAPHYLEA

Bladder nut

STAPHYLEACEAE

Genus of deciduous, spring-flowering shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers and bladderlike fruits. Fully hardy. Requires sun or partial shade and fertile, moist soil. Propagate species by softwood or greenwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall, selected forms by softwood or greenwood cuttings in summer.

S. colchica. Deciduous, upright shrub with stout shoots. H and S 11½ft (3.5m). Erect panicles of bell-shaped, white flowers in late spring, are followed by inflated, greenish-white fruits. Bright green leaves each consist of 3–5 ovate leaflets. Z6–9

S. holocarpa ‘Rosea’ illus. p.111.

S. pinnata (Bladder nut) illus. p.110.

Statice bellidifolia. See *Limonium bellidifolia*.

Statice suworowii. See *Psylliostachys suworowii*.

STAUNTONIA

LARDIZABALACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their leaves, flowers and fruits. Male and female flowers are borne on separate plants. Frost hardy to frost tender. Grow in any well-drained soil and in sun or partial shade. Prune in early spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by stem cuttings in summer or fall.

S. hexaphylla illus. p.192.